



Gaming Smartphone

Game On... And On... And On...

Mobile gaming has evolved from a casual pastime to a competitive and immersive platform, reshaping how games are played and experienced. The gaming smartphone segment has undergone remarkable maturation, with manufacturers pushing boundaries to deliver unparalleled performance and innovation. Today's gaming smartphones boast state-of-the-art cooling systems to keep thermals in check during extended gaming sessions, specialized gaming enhancements for smoother performance, and dedicated co-processors to handle demanding tasks with ease. These devices are no longer just smartphones – they are portable gaming powerhouses. AI-powered graphics optimization ensures sharper visuals while preserving battery life, while variable refresh rate technologies adapt to deliver fluid gameplay regardless of the scene's complexity. Additionally, advanced haptic feedback systems provide a tactile layer of immersion, making actions like gunfire or driving feel incredibly realistic. Innovations like shoulder triggers, customizable gaming modes, and integration with gaming peripherals further bridge the gap between mobile devices and traditional gaming platforms. This category celebrates the best gaming smartphones that deliver console-quality gaming experiences on the go. With these advancements, gaming is no longer confined to PCs, laptops, or consoles. It recognizes that a high-performance smartphone is all you need to join the ranks of serious gamers.

Winner & Best Buy: iQOO 12

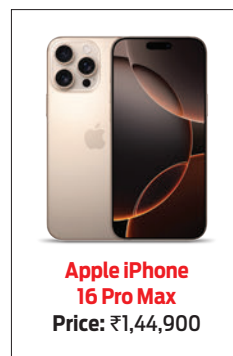
The iQOO 12 is a flagship powerhouse that has redefined gaming performance, delivering exceptional thermal management during intense gaming sessions. What sets the iQOO 12 apart is its comprehensive approach to the flagship experience. Beyond its gaming prowess, it features a stunning 144Hz display with remarkable color accuracy and peak brightness, ensuring immersive gaming visuals. It excels in photography with its versatile triple-camera setup, featuring a 50MP primary sensor and impressive 64MP periscope telephoto lens. The 5000mAh battery provides substantial gaming endurance, while the 120W fast charging technology ensures minimal downtime. The iQOO 12 stands as a testament to balanced innovation, offering premium features and unmatched gaming performance at a competitive price point, which is why it has emerged as both the Zero1 Award winner and Best Buy winner in the gaming smartphones category.



iQOO 12
Price: ₹52,999

Runner-Up: Apple iPhone 16 Pro Max

The iPhone 16 Pro Max emerges as our runner-up in the gaming smartphones category, showcasing Apple's prowess in delivering a premium gaming experience. It is powered by the A18 Pro chip and sets itself apart with exclusive access to console-quality AAA mobile games like Resident Evil Village and Assassin's Creed Mirage, offering gaming experiences unavailable on other platforms. Its stunning 6.9-inch Super Retina XDR OLED display with ProMotion 120Hz refresh rate delivers fluid visuals, while the peak brightness of 1,662 nits ensures clear visibility in any lighting condition. Built with an aerospace-grade titanium frame, the phone maintains excellent thermal management during extended gaming sessions, though some heating is noticeable during intensive tasks. While the iPhone 16 Pro Max may not top synthetic benchmarks compared to some Android competitors, its real-world gaming performance remains impressive thanks to iOS's optimized gaming ecosystem. The 4,685mAh battery provides sustainable gaming sessions. Combined with its studio-grade speakers and premium build quality, the iPhone 16 Pro Max stands as a compelling choice for gamers deeply invested in the Apple ecosystem, despite its premium price point.



Apple iPhone 16 Pro Max
Price: ₹1,44,900

—Siddharth Chauhan | siddharth@digit.in